Elisa Baldazzi

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics, University of Bologna
elisa.baldazzi3@unibo.it | elisabaldazzi.github.io
LinkedIn: elisa-baldazzi | X: @elibaldazzi

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Economics of Education, Gender Economics, Applied Microeconomics, Social Policy

CURRENT POSITIONS

Research Assistant, University of Trento, Italy Nov 2026 – Present
GENESIS project: *Gender Attitudes and Child Socioemotional Skills* (PNRR)
PI: Dr. Daniela Piazzalunga

Ph.D. Candidate, University of Bologna, Italy 2023 – Present
Thesis submitted; currently under external review

EDUCATION

University of Bologna, Italy 2023 – 2027 (expected)
Ph.D. in Economics – Interdisciplinary Ph.D. in Public Governance, Management, and Policy
Supervisors: Prof. Pietro Biroli and Prof. Marina Della Giusta

London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE), UK Sep 2025 – Apr 2026
Visiting Ph.D. Student, Department of Social Policy
Host: Prof. Almudena Sevilla. Affiliated with the *Women in Social and Public Policy Research Hub* (WISPPRH)

University of Bologna, Italy 2021 – 2023
M.Sc. in Economics, Economics Track (focus on Microeconomics)
Thesis: *Perception of Corruption: Survey-based Evidence from Italy*

University of Bologna, Italy 2018 – 2021
B.Sc. in Management and Marketing, with honors

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Be Prepared" for School: Scouting and School Outcomes in England
Previously circulated as *"The Impact of Scouting on School Absences and Crime Rate: Evidence from England"*
Winner of the María Jesús San Segundo Award (AEDE), 2026

Abstract: Scouting and Guiding are among the largest and most enduring youth organisations in the world, yet their effects on children have rarely been studied with causal methods. Exploiting the staggered opening of Scout and Girlguiding groups within walking distance of English schools between 2006 and 2018, I estimate the effect of gaining local access to a group on school absence, behaviour and attainment using a doubly-robust difference-in-differences design. The opening of a group within 0.75 km of a school reduces the unauthorised absence rate by about 9 percent and the suspension rate by about 10 percent, with effects that build up over the years after the opening, while permanent exclusions do not change. Openings are not predicted by schools' prior outcomes, authorised absence does not fall, and neither placebo openings in time nor openings of sports charities reproduce the effects, which also hold across distances, treatment definitions and estimators. The fall in unexplained absence and truancy is concentrated in schools where persistent absence and suspensions are common, and it is in the secondary schools of this kind that GCSE attainment shows suggestive gains. Individual-level evidence from Understanding Society points to the same channel: children in areas where a group opens are less likely to report truanting, watch less television and spend

more time with friends outside the home. These effects are comparable in size to those of school-based attendance and behaviour interventions, but come from a volunteer-run organisation operating outside school at almost no public cost.

PUBLICATIONS

- *Do LVLMs See Stereotypes as We Do? A Social Science Framework for Evaluating LVLMs' Recognition and Explanation of Stereotypes in Images*, with Marco Madeddu, Chiara Ferrando, Horacio Jarquín Vásquez, Marina Della Giusta, and Viviana Patti. *Proceedings of CLiC-it 2026*.

WORKING PAPERS

- *Seeing Stereotypes*, with Pietro Biroli, Marina Della Giusta, and Florent Dubois. arXiv:2503.02146

WORK IN PROGRESS

- *Words That Matter: Gender, Ethnicity, and Performance Assessment in the Workplace*, with Marina Della Giusta, Sylvia Jaworska, Giovanni Razzu, and Almudena Sevilla.
- *Sex Education: Mandatory School Programmes and Adolescent Health in Europe*, with Chiara Gastaldi and Andrea Rebucini.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Intern, INAPP – National Institute for the Analysis of Public Policies 2025

- Contributed to the design of a survey administered in Italian schools on students' educational and career choices.
- Literature review and comparative analysis of European education systems.

Research Assistant, CUBE Project, University of Bologna 2025

- Data collection, data cleaning and empirical analysis.

Research Assistant, University of Bologna 2022

- Designed and distributed survey instruments for a study on corruption perception.
- Data cleaning, management and econometric analysis in Stata and R.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, Microeconomics (undergraduate), University of Bologna 2024, 2026

- Led practical sessions and tutorials (2024); one-to-one meetings with students (2026).
- Prepared and graded midterm and final exams.

FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS

Marco Polo Scholarship, University of Bologna 2025
Funding for the visiting period at LSE

Ph.D. Scholarship, University of Bologna 2023 – 2026
Contrasting Gender Inequalities in Human Capital Formation

AWARDS AND HONORS

María Jesús San Segundo Award, AEDE 2026
For the paper *"Be Prepared" for School: Scouting and School Outcomes in England*

Hack4BetterLives, Fondazione per la Scuola 2024
For data visualization and analysis of OECD socio-emotional skills data

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2027 (scheduled): CSWEP Session at AEA/ASSA Annual Meeting (Washington, DC)

2026: 41st AIEL Conference (Rome); XXXIV Meeting of the Economics of Education Association (Logroño); International Workshop of Applied Economics of Education (Catanzaro); HE Junior Seminar (Rotterdam); Workshop on Frontiers in Measurement and Survey Methods (Rende); Early Career Workshop in Economics & Financial Mathematics (Verona); 19th UNITO-CCA Ph.D. Workshop in Economics (Turin); BHEPPE Seminar (Bologna)

2025: European Society for Population Economics – ESPE (Naples); Workshop on the Economics of Education (Leuven); 4th Workshop on Gender and Economics (Luxembourg); Bolzano Applied Microeconomics Workshop; Internal Seminar, University of Bologna

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Software: Stata, R, LaTeX
Methods: Survey design, data visualization
Languages: Italian (native), English (fluent), Spanish (advanced), German (basic)

REFERENCES

Prof. Pietro Biroli
University of Bologna
pietro.biroli@unibo.it

Prof. Marina Della Giusta
University of Torino
marina.dellagiusta@unito.it

Prof. Almudena Sevilla
London School of Economics
a.sevilla@lse.ac.uk